



Monster Hunter 4G

After the cult success of Monster Hunter Tri, Monster Hunter 4G releases on Nintendo DS and is reviewed: <http://dgit.in/mh4gnds>



Living Room Board

Microsoft starts targeting a new audience with its new keyboard meant to be used in the living room <http://dgit.in/microKey>

From the labs

10% of the Sun's rays at different points during the experiment.

David Keath, famous for his talks on the subject, argues that while geo-engineering looks like an extreme step, the need for it will only increase as we continue to be unable to reduce carbon dioxide emissions. One of the reasons why geo-engineering is still not talked about in the open so much is because it promotes the notion that we don't need to reduce our carbon emissions since we can just, you know, throw some sulphate into the air and we'll be fine.

Another argument against releasing sulphates into the stratosphere is that it addresses only one issue of warming – which may also be just a symptom – without addressing the other pertinent issue of levels of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere. But we have a solution to that too.

Iron-seas

Mt. Pinatubo returns to help pro-climate manipulation scientists! When the volcano interrupted it also deposited around 40,000 tons of iron dust into the oceans. An environmental scientist studied the event and saw that it substantially brought down atmospheric carbon



Mt. Pinatubo, caught in a rare moment of non-eruption

dioxide. So the next method of reducing carbon dioxide in the atmosphere is by dumping iron into the sea.

The reason? See Phytoplankton are these single celled organisms found in the sea. They absorb carbon dioxide from the atmosphere, convert it to energy,

and when they die they take the hapless carbon dioxide to the bottom of the ocean, never to be heard of again. Iron promotes the growth of phytoplankton. Thus in theory more phytoplankton results in more carbon dioxide being sucked out from the atmosphere.

Phytoplankton are also suspected of being the reason the ice age lasted for so long. Researchers from Princeton University and Swiss Federal Institute of Technology in Zurich proved that dust borne by the wind carried iron to the region of the globe north of Antarctica, driving the growth of phytoplankton, leading to the removal of carbon dioxide from the atmosphere, thus amplifying the ice ages and making them much colder. Some even say there would have been no ice age on the planet at all if it wasn't for this sucking out of carbon dioxide from the atmosphere.

So on October 23, 1993, a crew of scientists dumped almost 1,000 pounds of iron into the sea, mixed with a colourless chemical that would help the crew track the patch which was 'fertilized'. Sure enough, the next day the scientists swore they could even smell the phytoplankton growing. They had succeed in increasing the growth of the helpful-plankton, but unfortunately all they were able to record was a three-fold increase in chlorophyll levels, not nearly enough to be practical.

In June 1995, researchers once again dumped iron into the ocean, except this time they ensured that the iron stayed near the surface and received sunlight. After this the researchers saw 30-fold increase in chlorophyll levels. This consumed an estimated 367 tonnes of carbon dioxide.

So Iron fertilization might actually work after all. But hold on though, there were still quite a few hang-ups to address before we actually took to making the oceans look a little less blue:

There are still concerns that this method could actually *increase* the



Phytoplankton will take care of that pesky CO²

amount of carbon dioxide in the air. The iron could also cause Diatom blooms, a type of algae which has entered a – for lack of a better word – 'blooming' lifestyle, may actually take over the phytoplankton, thus destroying exactly what we are trying to promote. The result – whatever carbon dioxide is being absorbed now disappears as well.

Should we be doing this at all then?

See lightning kills around 53 people a year in the US alone. Hurricane Katrina killed 1,833 people. And the effects of global warming will cause entire cities to disappear under-water. While the idea of bending nature seems heavy handed, the point remains that there has come a point when man must put up a fight against nature to protect himself.

The ideas are far from perfect, as we somewhat rightly guessed, but there is a strong need for them to be talked about, to be debated, because only then will we be able to figure out a solution to them if any.

Because, well, we respect nature and the earth and all that that entails, but when it comes down to the subject of life we would rather be on the side of the table which gives the orders. 